

job and saving our money. We believe that the road to success involves being good savers and, once we have six figures in our bank account, to purchase a black 'I've made it' Range Rover. We get taught to play it safe and not 'gamble our money away'.

It's fair to say Zoe quit not too long after that. But getting a raise isn't the only issue. Where we keep our money is as well.

In fact, according to a 2015 BlackRock survey, women tend to leave 68 per cent of their wealth in savings accounts. That's 68 per cent of women's wealth being chipped away by inflation, every single year. On top of this, the wage gap is doing a number on us — how are we meant to close the wealth gap when we're making less, and the money we are putting away is also shrinking? It almost feels like a never-ending cycle.

The wealthy understand inflation; they had the privilege of receiving financial education, and, as a result, they know the key to building generational wealth is not through aggressively saving, but rather investing. They put money for their children not in savings accounts, but in funds that invest their wealth. Eighteen years of inflation is not something they would wish on their child, and neither should we.

This is why you should invest. Investors in training understand that, instead of stashing their cash in their mattress or in a bank account where their interest rate is between 0.1 and 0.3 per cent, investing is a much more coherent way to beat inflation.

The stock market has returned 7 to 10 per cent annually, on average, over the last 40-plus years. This doesn't mean the stock market stays between 7 and 10 per cent each year; some years it's up 20 per cent and some years down 5 per cent, but it averages out to 7 to 10 per cent in the long run. The benefit of something going up 7 per cent when inflation is 2 per cent is that you get a 5 per cent advantage over inflation (as illustrated in [figure 1.1](#)).